

Adobe University Hackathon 2026

Case 07 | GlowTheory (Beauty D2C)

Clean beauty brand mislabeled by AI and losing ingredient prompts

Industry: Beauty / Personal care D2C | Theme: Speak to Agents - Brand Visibility

Practice paper | Timebox 45:00 | Suggested: read 5 | Q1-Q4 as marked | buffer 2

Unofficial - for team practice only. Official Round 2 may differ.

Scenario

GlowTheory sells fragrance-free skincare for sensitive skin. Instagram and influencer SEO referrals are strong. Google ranks for a few ingredient terms.

AI answers to 'niacinamide serum for sensitive skin India', 'fragrance free moisturizer fungal acne' often recommend 2 bigger D2C brands. GlowTheory sometimes appears with wrong claims ('contains essential oils' - it does not) or is labeled 'luxury' despite mid pricing.

Case facts / data

- Mention 20%, citation 6%, sentiment mixed; wrong-ingredient hallucinations in ~1 of 5 mentions.
- INCI / ingredient lists are in images on PDPs, not text. 'Free-from' claims are in a popup.
- Blog has good dermatologist interview content but no author credentials displayed.
- Competitor citations lean on dermatologist Instagram carousels transcribed elsewhere + Amazon A+ text.
- GPTBot allowed; however /products/* returns different content to bots vs users (incomplete bot view).
- No Wikipedia. Reddit skincare community mentions are rare; when present, positive on gentle formula.
- Losing cluster: fungal-acne-safe routines. Weak win: branded shade/serum names.

Questions

Question 1 (8-10 min)

Why might AI invent wrong ingredients for GlowTheory? Connect hallucinations to onsite content format and offsite sparse authority.

Question 2 (8-10 min)

Write a 21-day plan to make ingredient truth machine-readable and citable. Include PDP changes, FAQ, and one earned-media play.

Question 3 (8-10 min)

Should GlowTheory chase broad 'best serum India' prompts or niche 'sensitive / fungal-acne-safe' prompts first? Defend with expected mention/citation ROI.

Question 4 (8-10 min)

Define an answer-quality rubric for beauty GEO (accuracy of ingredients, price band, suitable skin type, citation source). How would a weekly review work for a 3-person team?

Answer frame (use on every question)

- One-line bottom line first
- 2-3 causes tied to case facts (do not invent numbers)
- Prioritized actions: quick wins vs later bets
- Metrics / how you know it worked
- Optional one-line Adobe / agent angle if it fits

Judged on: analytical thinking, strategic approach, actionable insights. Write like a sharp student analyst under time pressure - specific, not buzzwordy.

Team tip: attempt alone under timer, then compare notes. Focus debate on prioritization and metrics - not who wrote longer answers.